Halloween

Warmup: everyone go around the room and say one thing you know about Halloween/Trick-or-Treating.

Brief History

In Ancient Times:

1. Atheneaus of Naucratis (birth-death years) wrote that the Ancient Greeks had a custom in which

kids dress as birds and go door-to-door singing songs

1. If the owner of a house did not give them food, they would cause mischief

16th Century Scotland:

1. Guising
2. Etymology: what does this word mean?
3. Definition: tradition in which children go door-to-door in disguise and receive gifts
4. Can be traced to Celtic festival of *Samhain*, in which people impersonated spirits as protection from them, received gifts in exchange

Trick-or-treating:

1. Guising spreads to North America first in Canada (1911), later to Chicago (1920), and subsequently the rest of the U.S.
2. The practice of getting food from strangers, called Ragamuffin Day, had existed since 1870 but was commonly done on Thanksgiving
3. Trick-or-treating became more and more popular, with a brief pause due to rationing during WWII

What do we actually do?

Caveat: New York Halloween is different from the rest of the country

Myth vs. Fact

Guess which of these traditions we actually do on Halloween put each of these slide-by-slide with an accompanying photo

1. Wear costumes
2. Go to multiple houses
3. Say the full phrase “Trick-or-treat, smell my feet, give me something good to eat!”
4. TP (toilet paper) people’s houses

Things we do

As much candy as possible: Insert photo of NYC apt building trick-or-treating sign-up sheet

1. Start at the top of an apartment building and work your way down
2. Largest building (high-rises) usually the best
3. Stores also give out candy
4. Get a large pillowcase to collect candy
5. Pumpkin carving

After trick-or-treating

1. Empty the pillowcase onto the floor
2. Trade candy with siblings/friends
3. Eat candy
4. Feel sick

Things we don't do

1. The 'trick' part of trick-or-treat
2. Going from building-to-building (mostly – include the link of brownstones https://www.instagram.com/p/DeUcz-WETzg/)
3. Wear elaborate costumes (normal people)

After the age of 16

1. Nobody goes trick-or-treating
2. Halloween parties
3. Usually pretty cringe
4. Costumes get lazier

FILL IN picture of cat costume but like the lazy versions where people just put on cat ears or whatever

Activity, if we have time: Students: GUESS which types of costumes are most popular in the U.S. (maybe like top 5) Then reveal answers.